

# Aatman Vaidya

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## Employment

**Research Assistant, Aalto University** Helsinki, Finland 08/2026 – Present  
Working with [Juhi Kulshrestha](#) to analyse **315K+ ChatGPT** conversations from the UK, Germany, and Spain. Examining how people actually use AI across work, productivity, health, and other domains. Investigating the **economic**, **societal**, and **safety** implications of large-scale AI adoption, with the goal of informing safer, more inclusive, and human-centered AI systems.

**Research Engineer, Tattle Civic Tech** Delhi, India 08/2023 – 09/2025  
Conducted research on **AI safety and online harms**, developing tools and datasets to understand online abuse. Created a dataset on **gender-based violence** and developed **AI safety benchmark** for **hate** and **sex-related** harms in India. **Evaluated** the safety and performance of AI systems across Indian languages, and collaborated with NGOs to red-team AI systems and develop **safety guardrails**.

## Education

**M.A. Computational Linguistics**, University of Tübingen, Germany 2025–Present  
**B.Tech Computer Science**, Ahmedabad University, India 2019–2023

## Selected Publications

- [Aatman Vaidya](#), Kiran Garimella. "Information Seeking Across Web and Generative AI" *Under Review at CHI 2027*
- [Aatman Vaidya](#), Kiran Garimella. "Quantifying the Illicit Ecosystem of Betting Apps in India" *ICWSM 2026 Best Paper*
- [Aatman Vaidya](#). "Transfer Learning for Multilingual Polarization Detection" *SemEval @ ACL 2026*
- Arnav Arora et al. "The Uli Dataset: An Exercise in Experience Led Annotation of oGBV" *Workshop on Online Harms and Abuse @ NAACL 2024 Outstanding Paper*
- [Aatman Vaidya](#) et al. "Analysis of Indic Language Capabilities in LLMs" ArXiv Preprint 2024

Complete publication list: [Google Scholar](#)

## Policy and AI Safety Work

- Investigated and mapped the commercial ecosystem of **non-consensual AI-generated** imagery in India, focusing on supply chains, payment systems, platforms, and regulatory gaps. Published as an investigative report in **Pulitzer Center** [[Report Link](#)].
- Contributed 2,000 region-specific prompts on **hate** and **sex-related** harms in India to the **MLCommons Alluminate** benchmark dataset. Identified gaps in the MLCommons v0.5 hazards taxonomy, particularly around culturally contextual harms that fall outside formal legal definitions of crime in South Asia.
- Worked with [Kiran Garimella](#) on a multi-source study quantifying **financial scams** in India, linking promotion on Meta ads to downstream user harms despite platform policies. Highlighted the use of **AI-generated deepfakes** in deceptive advertising and gaps in current regulatory framework.
- Member of a working group that authored a **policy report** on **Open Source AI** in India, analysing risks and proposing recommendations for government and the developer community.
- **Work Mention and Media Coverage:** [NY Times](#), [World Economic Forum](#), [Center for Democracy & Technology](#)

## Technical Skills

**Programming:** Python (advanced); JavaScript, Elixir (intermediate)

**ML/Data:** PyTorch, TensorFlow, SQL, Pandas, NumPy, NetworkX, MLOps

**Causal Inference:** Synthetic Control, Difference-in-Difference, Placebo Testing

## References

**Kiran Garimella**, Rutgers University ..... [kiran.garimella@rutgers.edu](mailto:kiran.garimella@rutgers.edu)  
**Tarunima Prabhakar**, Tattle Civic Tech ..... [tarunima@tattle.co.in](mailto:tarunima@tattle.co.in)